

Construction of Adjectives



The + adjective (people in general)

- *We use **the + adjective** to talk about a group of people in general.*
- “the poor” = poor people | “the blind” = blind people
- Common adjectives:
 - blind, deaf, sick, healthy, rich, old, young, unemployed, injured, living, dead
 - **The poor** get less support than the rich.
 - The organization helps **the disabled**.
 - Guide dogs help **the blind**.
 - **The unemployed** can apply for jobs here.
 - We remember **the living** as well as **the dead**.



Nationality adjectives:

- *We also use this form for national groups:*
 - the English | the French | the Chinese | the Japanese | the Spanish
 - the Dutch | the Irish | the Welsh | the Swiss | the British
- **The French** are famous for their cuisine.
- **The Japanese** work long hours.
- The country was ruled by **the British**.



Adjective + one / ones (avoid repetition)

- *We use **one / ones** to avoid repeating nouns.*
 - adjective + one (singular)
 - adjective + ones (plural)
- Don't buy the expensive **apples**; get the cheaper **ones**.
- Hard **beds** are healthier than soft **ones**.
- I lost my old **camera**; this is a new **one**.



it + be + adjective + of somebody + to + verb

- *We use this to describe **someone's character or behavior.***
- **Common adjectives:**
- kind, nice, generous, rude, selfish, stupid, foolish, clever, polite, cruel,
 - **It was kind of you to help him.**
 - **It was stupid of them to leave the door open.**
 - **It was very generous of you to help us.**
 - **It was rude of him to interrupt.**



It + be + adjective + for somebody + to + verb

- *Used for **difficulty, safety, convenience** for somebody to do*
- **Common adjectives:**
- **easy, difficult, hard, dangerous, safe, possible, impossible, convenient**
 - **It was dangerous for children to cross** the road alone.
 - **It is difficult for me to understand** this topic.
 - **It was impossible to enter** the building.
 - **Would it be convenient for you to meet** tomorrow?



Subject + be + adjective + to + verb

- *Used to express feelings or reactions*
- **Common adjectives:**
- **happy, sad, glad, pleased, delighted, sorry, disappointed, amazed, astonished**
 - **I'm delighted to see you.**
 - **He was glad to leave school.**
 - **She was sad to hear the news.**
 - **They were disappointed to fail the exam.**



Be + adjective + to + verb

(tendency / behavior)

- ***Shows habit, tendency, or willingness***
- **People are prone to make** mistakes when tired.
- **He is reluctant to lend** money.
- **I am willing to help** you.
- **She is slow to understand** new ideas.
- **I am inclined to believe** him.



The first / the last / the next + to + verb

- *Used to show order*
- **Examples:**
- **He was the first person to arrive.**
- **She was the last student to leave.**
- **This will be the next film to be released.**



Structure	Use	Example
the + adj	people in general	the poor, the rich
adj + one/ones	avoid repetition	the cheaper ones
it is + adj + of	character	It was kind of you
it is + adj + for	difficulty/safety	It is easy for me
adj + to	feelings	happy to see you
prone/reluctant etc.	tendency	prone to make mistakes
the first/last + to	order	the first to arrive